

GEOGRAPHY

INDIAN GEOGRAPHY



INDIAN NATURAL VEGETATION

MODULE - 2

VEGETATION OF INDIA

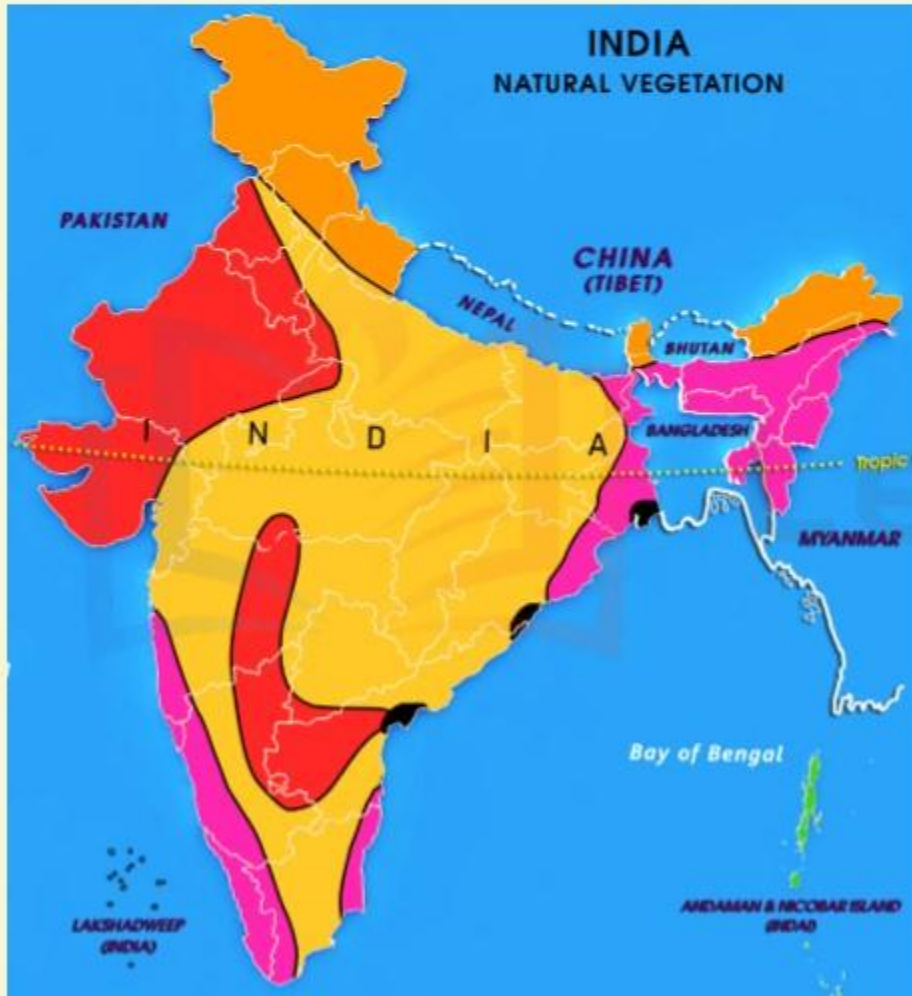
- TYPES OF FORESTS

TYPE NO. 3



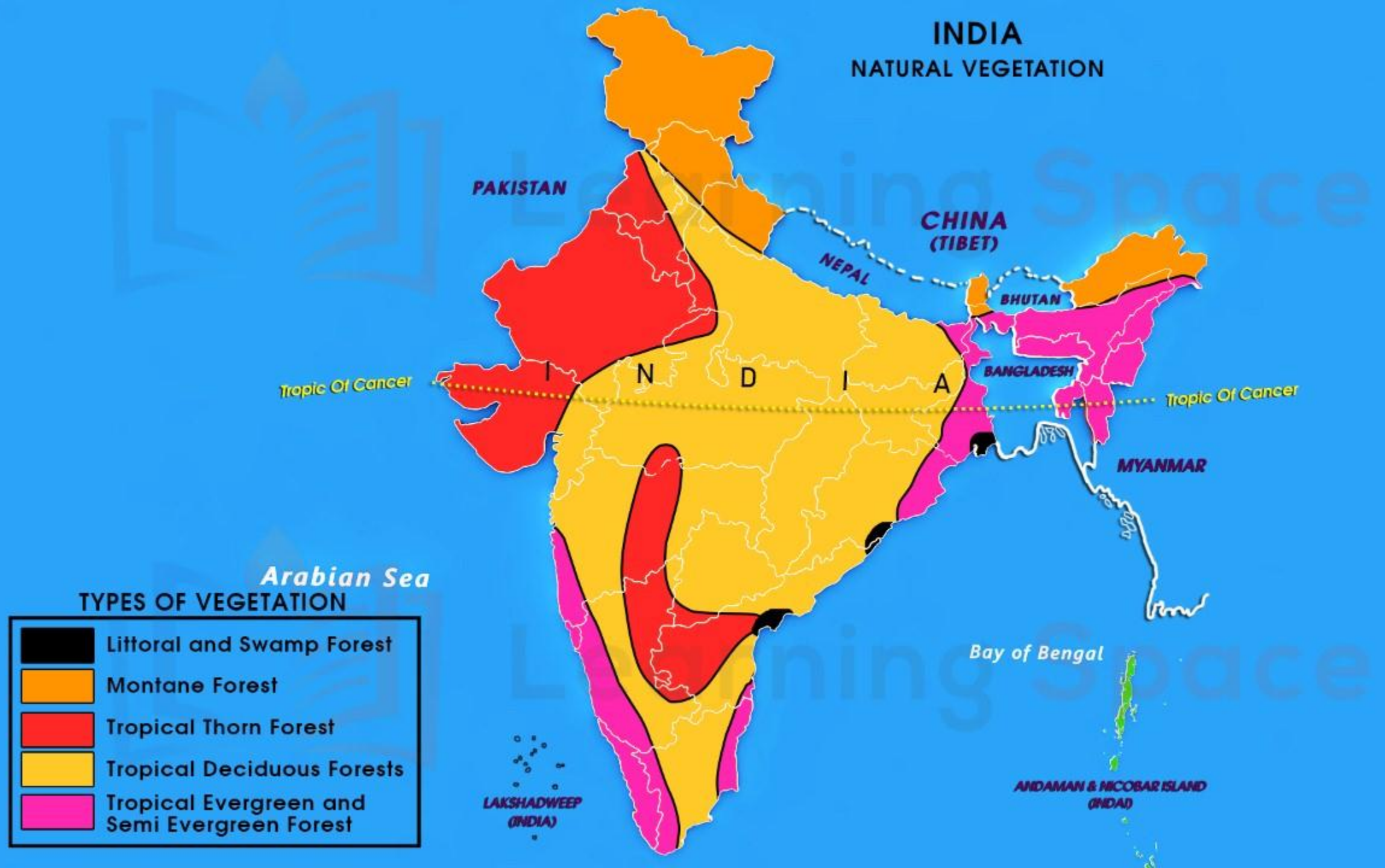
TYPES OF FORESTS

TROPICAL THORN FORESTS



- 1 Tropical thorn forests occur in the areas which receive rainfall less than 50 cm.
- 2 These consist of a variety of grasses and shrubs.
- 3 It includes semi-arid areas of south west Punjab, Haryana, Rajasthan, Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh.

INDIA NATURAL VEGETATION



TYPE NO. 3



TYPES OF FORESTS

TROPICAL THORN FORESTS



- 4 In these forests, plants remain leafless for most part of the year and give an expression of scrub vegetation.
- 5 Important species found are babool, ber, and wild date palm, khair, neem, khejri, palas, etc.
- 6 Tussocky grass grows upto a height of 2 m as the under growth.

TYPE NO. 3



TYPES OF FORESTS

TROPICAL THORN FORESTS



TABLE FOR QUICK REVISION

TABLE FOR QUICK REVISION	
Climate	Rainfall < 50 cm, temperature = 25-30°C
Area	Semi arid regions of North-Western India and interior of Peninsular Plateau.
Unique characteristics	Scrub like vegetation

TYPE NO. 4

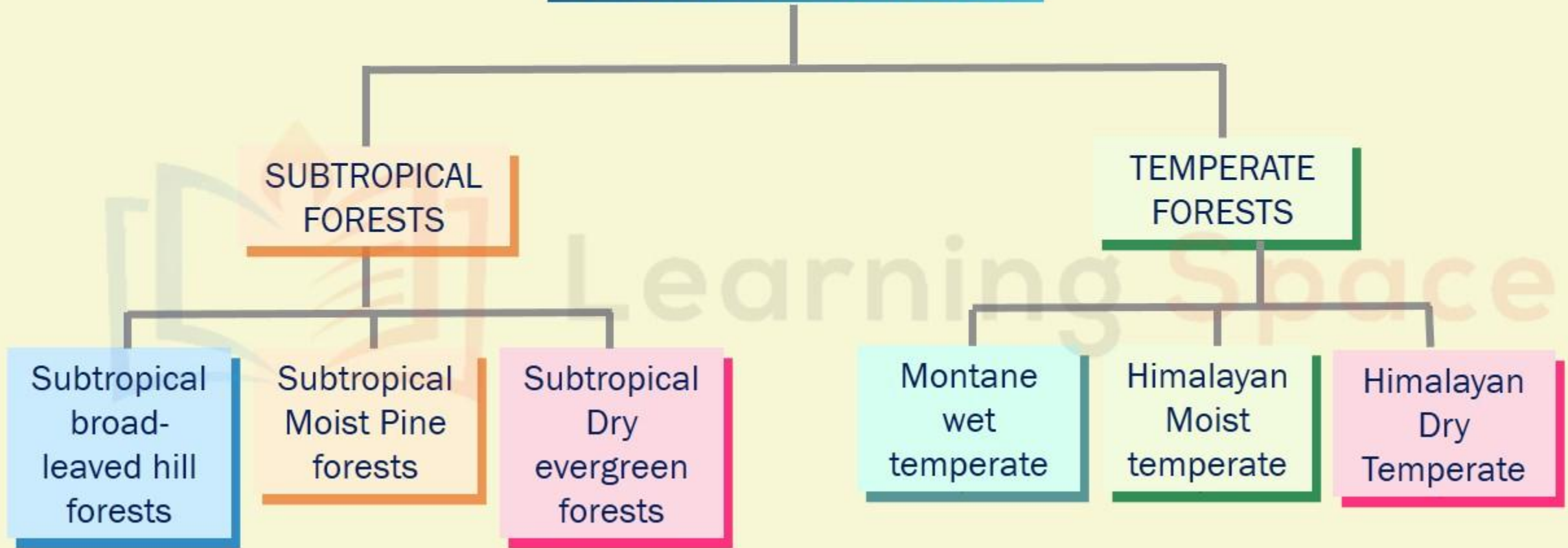


TYPES OF FORESTS

MONTANE FORESTS



MONTANE FORESTS

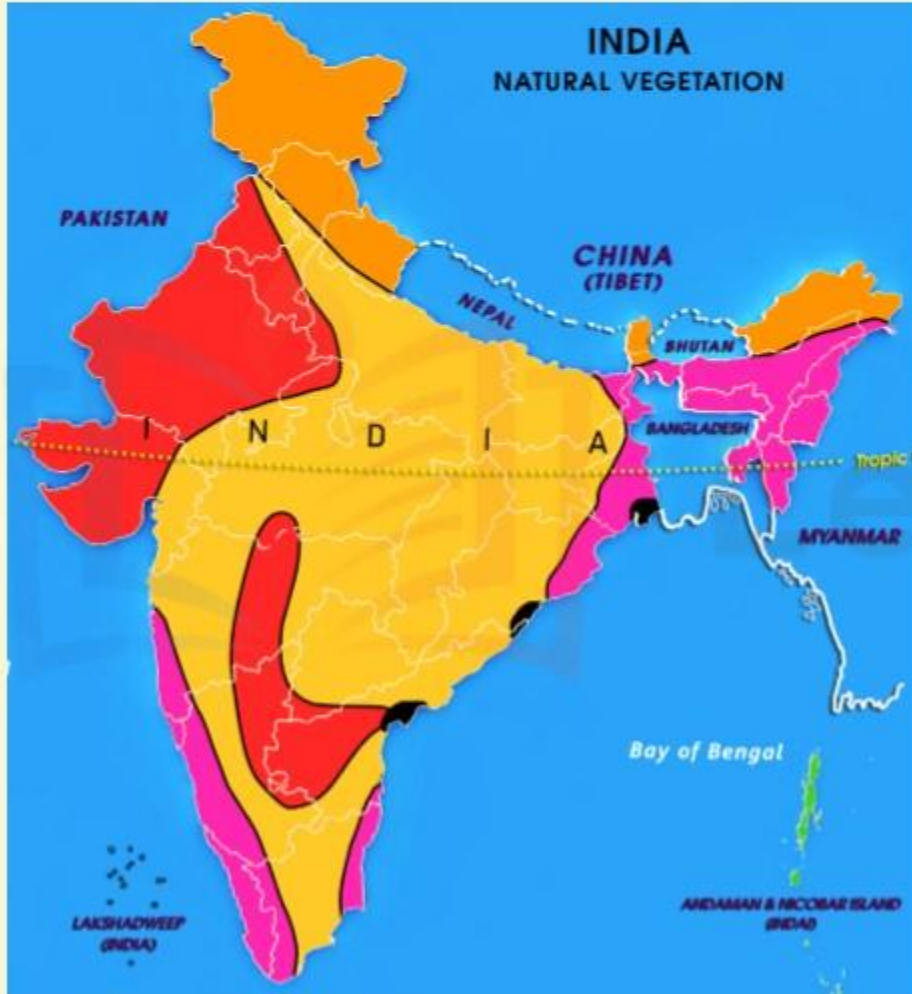


TYPE NO. 4



TYPES OF FORESTS

MONTANE FORESTS



- 1 In mountainous areas, the decrease in temperature with increasing altitude leads to a corresponding change in natural vegetation.
- 2 Mountain forests can be classified into two types, the northern mountain forests and the southern mountain forests.
- 3 The Himalayan ranges show a succession of vegetation from the tropical to the tundra, which change in with the altitude.

TYPE NO. 4



TYPES OF FORESTS

MONTANE FORESTS



Chestnuts

- 4 Deciduous forests are found in the foothills of the Himalayas.
- 5 It is succeeded by the **wet temperate type of forests** between an altitude of 1,000-2,000 m.
- 6 In the higher hill ranges of northeastern India, hilly areas of West Bengal and Uttaranchal, **evergreen broad leaf trees** such as oak and chestnut are predominant.

TYPE NO. 4



TYPES OF FORESTS

MONTANE FORESTS



Chir pine



Deodar

7 Between 1,500-1,750 m, **pine forests** are also well-developed in this zone, with Chir Pine as a very useful commercial tree.

8 Deodar, a highly valued endemic species grows mainly in the western part of the Himalayan range.

9 Deodar is a durable wood mainly used in construction activity. Similarly, the **chinar** and the **walnut**, which sustain the famous **Kashmir handicrafts**, belong to this zone.

TYPE NO. 4**TYPES OF FORESTS**
MONTANE FORESTS**UPSC CIVIL SERVICES**
PRELIMS - 2018**MCQs DISCUSSION****GEOGRAPHY**

SESSION - 9

25th May, 2018**9**

Please refer to this module for further information on Transhumance by the mentioned tribes

10

Blue pine and spruce appear at altitudes of 2,225-3,048 m.

11

At many places in this zone, temperate grasslands are also found. But in the higher reaches there is a transition to Alpine forests and pastures.

12

Silver firs, junipers, pines, birch and rhododendrons, etc. occur between 3,000-4,000 m. However, these pastures are used extensively for transhumance by tribes like the Gujjars, the Bakarwals, the Bhotiyas and the Gaddis.

TYPE NO. 4



TYPES OF FORESTS

MONTANE FORESTS



Junipers



Rhododendron

- 13** The southern slopes of the Himalayas carry a thicker vegetation cover because of relatively higher precipitation than the drier north-facing slopes.
- 14** At higher altitudes, mosses and lichens form part of the tundra vegetation.

TYPE NO. 4



TYPES OF FORESTS

MONTANE FORESTS



15 The southern mountain forests include the forests found in three distinct areas of Peninsular India viz, the **Western Ghats, the Vindhyas and the Nilgiris.**

16 As they are closer to the tropics, and only 1,500 m above the sea level, **vegetation is temperate in the higher regions, and subtropical on the lower regions of the Western Ghats,** especially in Kerala, Tamil Nadu and Karnataka.

17 The **temperate forests are called Sholas** in the Nilgiris, Anaimalai and Palani hills.

18 Some of the other trees of this forest of economic significance include, magnolia, laurel, cinchona and wattle. Such forests are also found in the Satpura and the Maikal ranges.

TYPE NO. 5



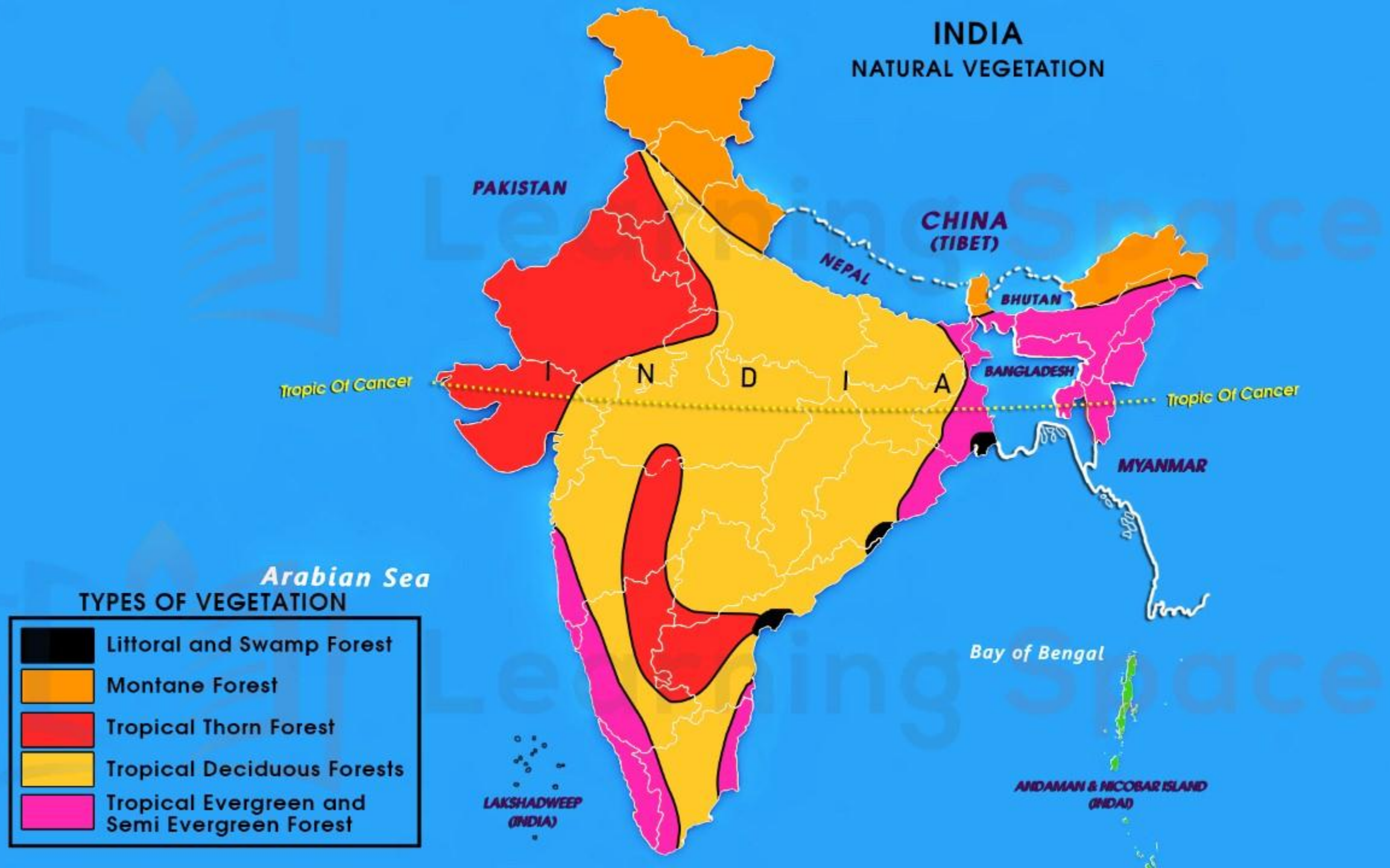
TYPES OF FORESTS

LITTORAL AND SWAMP FORESTS



- 1 India has a rich variety of wetland habitats.
- 2 About 70 per cent of this comprises areas under paddy cultivation.
- 3 The total area of wet land is about 4 million hectares.
- 4 Two sites Chilika Lake (Orissa) and Keoladeo National Park (Bharatpur) are protected as water-fowl habitats under the Convention of Wetlands of International Importance (Ramsar Convention).

INDIA NATURAL VEGETATION



TYPE NO. 5



TYPES OF FORESTS

LITTORAL AND SWAMP FORESTS



- 5 The country's wetlands have been grouped into eight categories, viz.
- the **reservoirs of the Deccan Plateau** in the south together with the lagoons and other wetlands of the south western coast.
 - the **vast saline expanses of Rajasthan**, Gujarat and the Gulf of Kachchh
 - freshwater lakes and reservoirs from Gujarat eastwards through Rajasthan** (Keoladeo National Park) and Madhya Pradesh.
 - the delta wetlands and **lagoons of India's east coast** (Chilika Lake).
 - the **freshwater marshes of the Gangetic Plain**.
 - the **floodplains of the Brahmaputra**; the marshes and swamps in the hills of northeast India and the Himalayan foothills.
 - the lakes and rivers of the **montane region of Kashmir** and Ladakh.
 - the mangrove forest and other wetlands of the **island arcs of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands**. Mangroves grow along the coasts in the salt marshes, tidal creeks, mud flats and estuaries.

TYPE NO. 5



TYPES OF FORESTS

LITTORAL AND SWAMP FORESTS



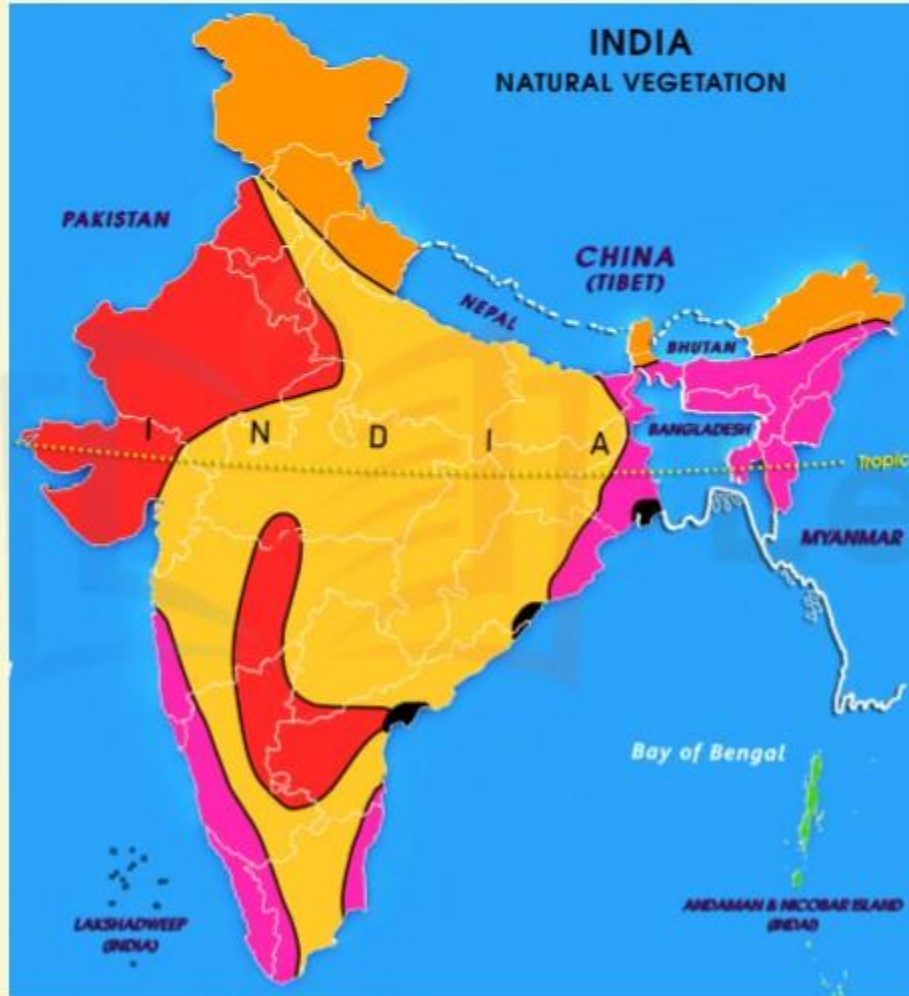
- 6** They consist of a number of salt-tolerant species of plants.
- 7** Crisscrossed by creeks of stagnant water and tidal flows, these forests give shelter to a wide variety of birds.
- 8** In India, the mangrove forests spread over 6,740 sq. km which is 7 per cent of the world's mangrove forests.

TYPE NO. 5



TYPES OF FORESTS

LITTORAL AND SWAMP FORESTS



- 9 They are highly developed in the Andaman and Nicobar Islands and the Sunderbans of West Bengal.
- 10 Other areas of significance are the Mahanadi, the Godavari and the Krishna deltas.
- 11 These forests too, are being encroached upon, and hence, need conservation.

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